

Historical artifacts

Archival research and digital timeline

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1 Historical thinking

Historical thinking asks us to consider why we examine the past in order to better understand the world around us and the world ahead of us. In EDUC 219, historical inquiry helps us become better informed citizens and education professionals by connecting evidence, institutions, events, and ideas to questions about schooling, democracy, access, diversity, and social justice.

2 Your group's work

Students will work individually and collaboratively to:

- Define criteria for identifying major historical events.
- Select two historical bookend events within a broader historical period.
- Identify and document two primary-source artifacts situated between those events.

- Create a physical historical timeline with a group.
- Contribute records to the class digital timeline/database.
- Identify whether timeline entries are classified as major events and whether they are directly related to education.

3 Historical documentation

For each event or artifact contributed to the class database, document the following information:

Field	Description
Event or artifact name	A concise, descriptive title
Record type	Event or artifact
Date or date range	Include an approximate date or range when an exact date is unavailable
Location	City, state/territory, region, nation, or other relevant location
Historical period	The broader period selected by your group
Summary	A brief factual description
Major event	1 = yes; 0 = no
Major-event rationale	Explain why the event does or does not meet your group's criteria
Education related	1 = yes; 0 = no
Education connection	Explain the item's relevance to schools, teaching, learning, literacy, educational access, or policy; use N/A when not applicable
Primary-source title	Title or description of the source
Creator	Person, organization, court, newspaper, institution, or other creator
Source date	Date the primary source was created or published
Repository	Archive, collection, library, or database where the source was found
Source URL	Stable link or repository permalink
Citation	Full citation in APA, MLA, or Chicago style
Trial connection	<i>Plessy</i> , <i>Brown</i> , both, or no direct connection
Trial connection note	Explain any connection to historical context, legal questions, educational access, or group research
Group and contributors	Timeline group and student names

Field	Description
Verification status	Draft, reviewed by group, or ready for class database

4 Class timeline roles

As we create the shared digital timeline, students may contribute through one of three roles:

- **Transcribers:** Integrate physical timelines into the class Excel database; document events and artifacts; and help scale or weight major and non-major events.
- **Coders:** Use the shared database to help generate a digital timeline. No software downloads are required.
- **Translators:** Work across the transcription and coding groups to identify, categorize, and highlight education-related events, sources, and themes.

5 Archive and primary-source resources

- [Moorland-Spingarn Research Center](#)
- [Schomburg Center for Research in Black Culture: Digital Schomburg](#)
- [Black Teacher Archive](#)
- [Colored Conventions Project](#)
- [Library of Congress: Educator Resources](#)
- [Smithsonian Online Virtual Archives](#)
- [Smithsonian Learning Lab](#)
- [National Archives: Research Databases](#)
- [National Archives: Educator Resources](#)
- [DocsTeach](#)
- [The HistoryMakers](#) — access on campus

6 Connection to the trials

The timeline and database will provide a shared historical resource for the course. Your group's research may connect directly to *Plessy v. Ferguson*, *Brown v. Board of Education*, both cases, or broader historical periods that help us understand the social, political, legal, and educational contexts surrounding the trials.

Use your archival work to identify evidence, historical context, educational themes, and questions that can strengthen your trial-group research and reenactment preparation.